

Indus Valley Civilisation

(Also known as Harappan Civilisation)

2500 BCE - 1500 BCE



Class Notes: History

Introduction & Location

- It is the earliest civilisation in the Indian subcontinent.
- Flourished between 2500 and 1500 BCE.
- Location: Around the Indus River and its tributaries.
- Region: North-west region of Indian subcontinent.



Indian
Subcontinent
=
भारतीय उपखंड



The Discovery (1920s)

- Discovered in the 1920s.
- Remains found: Buildings, pottery, toys, jewellery, seals.
- Archaeologist: A person who studies the remains of historical objects buried under the earth.
- Why 'Harappan'? Because Harappa was the first site to be discovered!

Archaeologist = पुरातत्वशास्त्रज्ञ
(जुनया वस्तूंचा अभ्यास करणारे)



Important Cities

1. Harappa (Pakistan)
2. Mohenjo-daro (Pakistan)
3. Lothal (India)
4. Dholavira (India)
5. Kalibangan (India)



Exam Tip:
Lothal and
Dholavira are
in India!
Don't confuse
them.



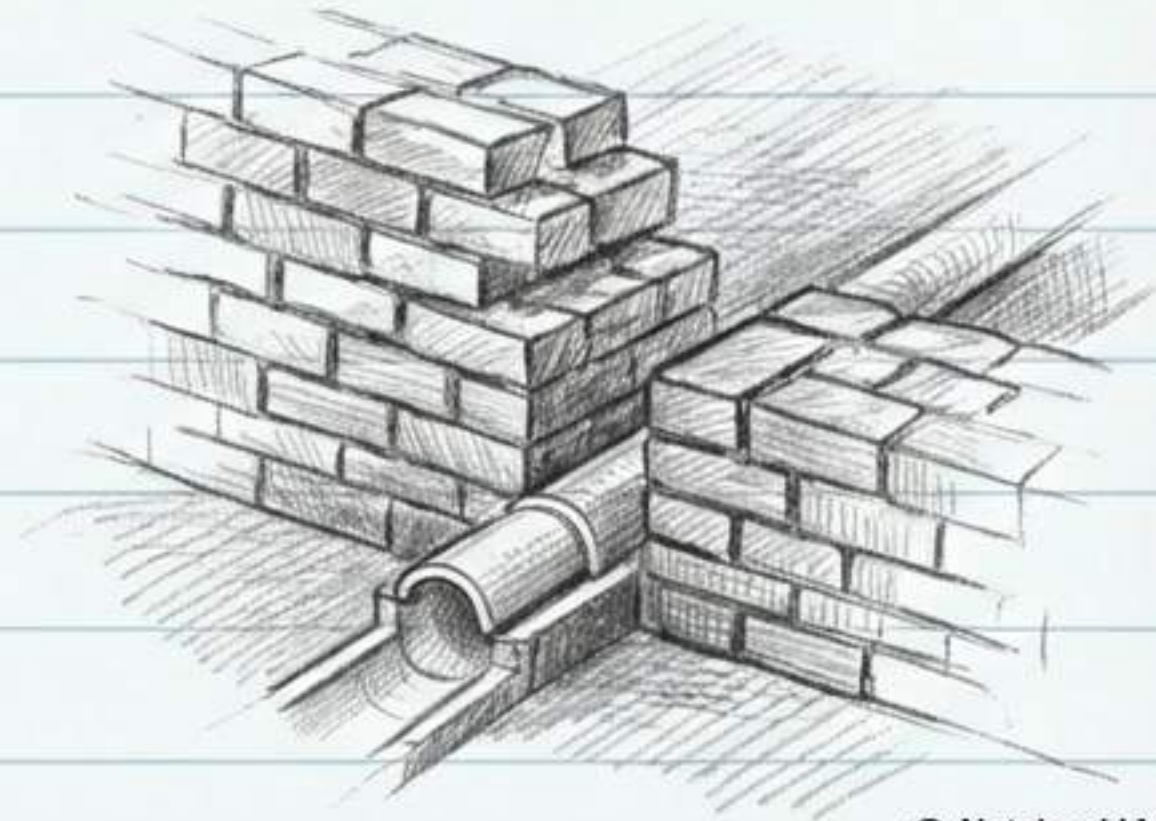
Memory Trick:

HM... LDK (Harappa, Mohenjo...
Lothal, Dholavira, Kalibangan)

Town Planning (Infrastructure)

- Cities were Well Planned (सुसज्ज नियोजन).
- Houses: Made of Baked Bricks. —→ Baked Bricks = भाजलेल्या विटा
- Water: Every house had water supply.
- Drainage: Proper Covered Drains connected to streets.
- Roads: Wide and straight.

Covered
drains =
High
Hygiene!

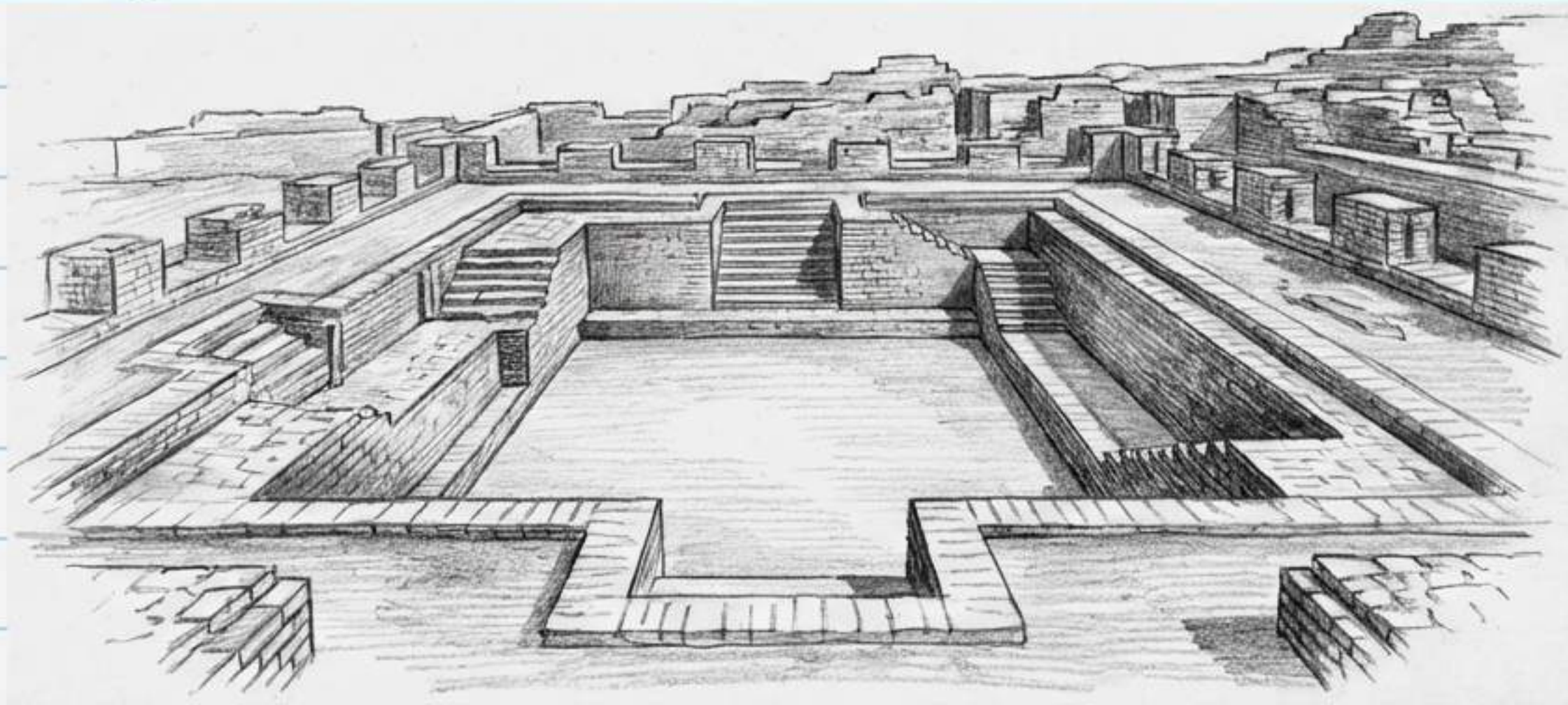


Important Buildings: The Great Bath

Location: Found at Mohenjo-daro.

- A big water tank.
- Surrounded by many rooms.
- Used for bathing on Special Occasions (religious festivals, etc.).

महास्नानगृह (विशेष प्रसंगी अंघोळ करण्यासाठी used).



Important Buildings: The Great Granary

Location: Found at Mohenjo-daro.

- A massive structure/building.
- Used to store large amounts of Food Grains (Wheat/Barley).
- Shows they had surplus food!



Great Granary = धान्याचे कोठार
(धान्य साठवण्यासाठी).

Occupations: Farming

How do we know? From remains of grains found.

Crops Grown:

- Wheat
- Rice
- Barley

Farmers = शेतकरी



Occupations: Crafts & Building

Skilled Craftsmen:

- Made beautiful jewellery, toys, and seals.
- Made Earthenware (clay pots).
- Materials used: Clay and Metals.

Builders:

- Constructed amazing buildings using baked bricks.

Craftsmen = कुशल कारागीर



Lifestyle & Trade

- Traders: Travelled to distant places to exchange goods.
- Clothes: Simple but Colourful.
- Jewellery:
 - Made of: Clay, Silver, Copper, Bronze, Gold.
 - Note: **Iron** is NOT in the list!



Common Mistake: Don't write 'Iron'. They didn't use it!

Culture & Religion

Religion:

- People worshipped Nature (निसर्ग पूजा).
- (Trees, animals, etc.)

The Script (Writing):

- Contained Pictures and Drawings as symbols.
- We have not fully understood it yet.

Script = लिपी (चित्रलिपी)



Decline of the Civilisation

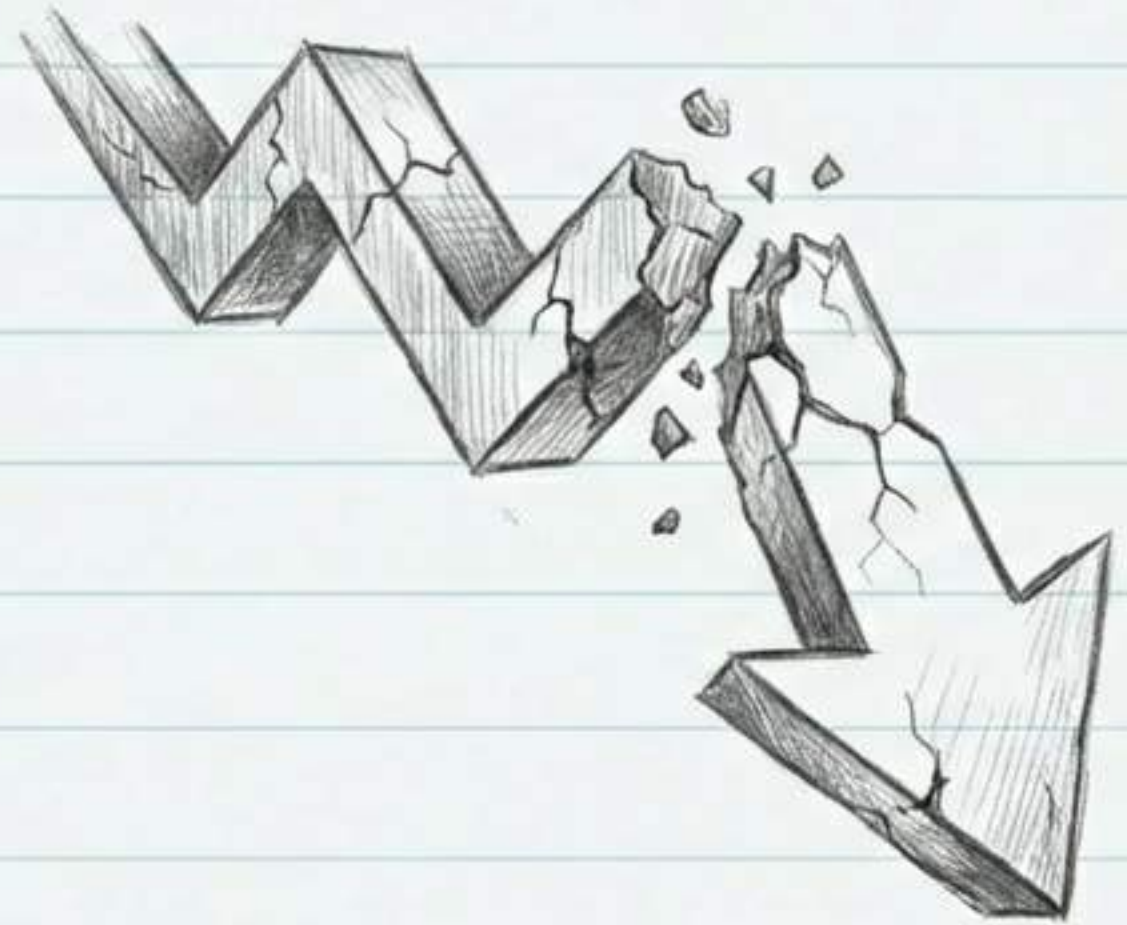
Time: Around 1500 BCE.

The Mystery: Exact reason is Not Known.

Possible Reasons:

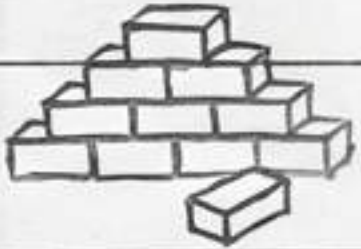
1. Spread of deadly Disease.
2. Natural Calamities: Floods or Earthquakes.
3. Enemy Attack.

Decline = न्हास / शेवट



⚡ QUICK RECAP (One-Shot)

Time	2500 – 1500 BCE
River	Indus (सिंधू नदी)
Main Cities	Harappa, Mohenjo-daro (PK), Lothal, Dholavira (IN)
Planning	Baked Bricks, Covered Drains
Structures	Great Bath, Great Granary
Jobs	Farmers (Wheat/Rice), Craftsmen, Traders
Metals	Gold, Silver, Copper, Bronze



Everything was well-organized!

Self Check: Are you ready?

1. IVC was discovered in which decade? → 1920s
2. Which river is central to IVC? → River Indus
3. Great Granary was used to store...? → Food Grains
4. True/False: Houses were made of baked bricks? → True
5. True/False: Great Granary was in Kalibangan?
→ False (It was Mohenjo-daro!)

